

Practice Quiz: Systems — Reading the Pattern as a Whole

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. In Active Inference terms, a crochet pattern is best understood as: A) A random sequence of instructions B) A generative model that predicts a finished object from specified inputs C) A purely decorative document D) A recipe that requires no interpretation
2. The gauge swatch section of a pattern functions as: A) An optional step for beginners only B) A way to use up extra yarn C) Model validation — testing whether the pattern's prior beliefs match your reality D) A decorative mini-project
3. What role does the stitch count at the end of a row serve in the pattern-as-system? A) It is decorative and can be ignored B) It is a checksum that lets you verify the model's predictions against your work C) It tells you how much yarn you have used D) It indicates the difficulty level of the row
4. The **Markov blanket** of the crochet pattern system is: A) The yarn itself B) The pattern document — the boundary between designer intention and crocheter execution C) The finished object D) The crochet hook
5. When two crocheters produce different-looking objects from the same pattern, this difference is best described as: A) One crocheter did it wrong B) Prediction error arising from different priors (tension, materials, interpretation) C) A flaw in the pattern D) Random chance with no systematic explanation
6. A pattern that includes detailed photos, schematics, and line-by-line video has a: A) Thinner Markov blanket than a text-only pattern B) Richer sensory interface — more information crosses the system boundary C) Weaker generative model D) Higher prediction error by default

7. The materials list in a crochet pattern specifies: A) The posterior outcomes of the project
B) The likelihood function C) The prior beliefs — assumptions the model makes before any stitching begins D) The prediction errors expected during the project

Part B: Short Answer

1. Choose a simple crochet pattern (real or imagined). Identify its priors, its likelihood function, and its predicted posterior. Explain each in one or two sentences.
2. Explain why switching to a different hook size than what the pattern calls for is equivalent to changing a precision parameter in the generative model. What effect does this have?
3. A crocheter says: "I never read the whole pattern before starting — I just go row by row." From a systems perspective, what information are they missing, and how might this lead to prediction errors later in the project?